# Skechers Email Review: “It's Back in Stock at SKECHERS.com”

Walker · US market · Executive summary first, evidence after

## Executive Summary

1. Executive Summary

A transactional back-in-stock alert that does its core job adequately but leaves significant conversion opportunity on the table. The product is identified, the CTA is present, and there's a cross-sell module — but the hero is undersized, the product image is tiny, and the emotional urgency that makes back-in-stock emails effective is almost entirely absent.

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Functional but underperforming. The email fulfills the basic promise (item is available again) without creating any real sense of urgency or desire.

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3. What's Working

Clear subject-line alignment — the email opens with "BACK IN STOCK ALERT!" in bold, which matches the subject line immediately.

Product details are explicit — Style #, Color, Size, and Price are all visible in a structured list, confirming this is the exact item the recipient waited for.

Single, unambiguous CTA — "BUY IT NOW" button is prominent and directly below the product block.

Cross-sell module — "You Might Also Be Interested In..." shows four product thumbnails with names and presumably prices, which is smart placement for recipients who find the item already gone again.

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4. What's Weak

Hero image is postage-stamp sized — the product photo is tiny relative to the email canvas. For a back-in-stock alert, the product image should be the emotional centerpiece; here it barely registers.

No urgency language — the subject and header say "back in stock" but nothing in the body communicates scarcity, time pressure, or demand (e.g., "Limited quantity," "Selling fast," "Only a few left"). This is the single most important driver of conversion in this email type and it's missing.

"Remember that style you love? It's back, but not for long. Shop it today before it's gone" header copy is buried in small gray text immediately below the logo — it reads like a disclaimer rather than a hook.

No product lifestyle or contextual imagery — the product thumbnail is catalog/product-page style and very small; a larger, worn-in-context image would drive purchase intent harder.

Customer service number callout feels like dead weight at this point in the conversion flow.

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5. Recommendations

Triple the product image size — make it the visual anchor of the email, not an afterthought in a spec table.

Add scarcity messaging — a line like "Only a few pairs left at your size" directly above or below the CTA would sharply lift urgency.

Elevate the preheader copy — move "It's back, but not for long. Shop it today before it's gone" into larger, styled headline text rather than small gray body copy.

Add a second CTA after the cross-sell module — recipients who browse the recommendations should have an easy re-entry path to the original item.

Remove or condense the customer service block — not relevant to the conversion moment; it diffuses focus.

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6. Bottom Line

This email communicates the facts but misses the feeling. Back-in-stock emails work because they create a fleeting window — the item is available *now*, but maybe not for long. That tension needs to be felt viscerally in the design. Larger product image, scarcity copy, and one line of urgency would likely meaningfully improve conversion without any structural rebuild.

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7. Evidence

| Module | Observation |

|---|---|

| Overall purpose | Back-in-stock transactional alert for a specific saved/waitlisted item |

| Hero / primary value prop | "BACK IN STOCK ALERT!" headline present but hero image is very small; no emotional urgency framing |

| Membership / benefits | None visible |

| Product discoverability / recommendations | "You Might Also Be Interested In..." shows 4 products with names, thumbnails, prices — solid module, well-placed |

| Utility / secondary modules | Customer service email + phone, footer links (Shipping & Returns, Store Locator), social icons |

| Bugs / friction / clarity issues | No visible rendering bugs; product image is intentionally included but rendered at a very small size that undermines its function |

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Technical Audit

Technical Audit — "It's Back in Stock at SKECHERS.com"

*From: SKECHERS

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1. Technical Summary

The email is structurally sound with standard Outlook/mobile compatibility boilerplate, but has three confirmed issues: a missing plain-text fallback, several images served over HTTP instead of HTTPS, and missing alt text on multiple images. SPF/DKIM authentication could not be verified through the relay.

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2. Link & Tracking Issues

26 tracking links route through click.emails.skechers.com (Salesforce Marketing Cloud click-redirect). Links were not probed — destination URLs and UTM parameters could not be verified.

Open-pixel beacon fires via click.emails.skechers.com/open.aspx?NBJUC24YDGGENDIIFTWBSORU5A... — standard SFMC implementation, no anomaly.

Three additional third-party beacon pixels fire on load via beacon.krxd.net for Salesforce DMP user-matching and ad impression tracking. These are zero-dimension (width="0" height="0") with display:none, consistent with standard practice.

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3. Rendering & Accessibility

*HTTP image sources (3 confirmed):

Images served over http://image.emails.skechers.com will be blocked by Gmail, Outlook, and most modern clients that enforce HTTPS mixed-content rules.

| Image UUID | src |

|---|---|

| dde00662 (Skechers logo) | http://image.emails.skechers.com/lib/fe3115707564047a731c78/m/1/dde00662-...png |

| 041c30ac | http://image.emails.skechers.com/lib/fe3115707564047a731c78/m/8/041c30ac-...png |

| f9b5ed32 | http://image.emails.skechers.com/lib/fe3115707564047a731c78/m/8/f9b5ed32-...png |

*Missing alt text (2 images):

041c30ac-21db-494b-a892-bbdbf4984b2a.png

f9b5ed32-ceef-41a6-8701-c0e0121ca99c.png

Both are content images (not decorative spacers), so the missing alt text breaks screen reader accessibility and degrades the image-blocked rendering experience.

*Other rendering notes:

user-scalable=0 in the viewport meta tag prevents pinch-zoom on mobile — an accessibility regression flagged under WCAG 1.4.4 (Resize Text).

is missing the http-equiv attribute: should be . This can cause character encoding fallback behavior in older clients.

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4. Personalization & Merge Tokens

HTML source is truncated, so full token inspection is not possible. No unresolved merge tokens (e.g. %%first_name%%, [FIRST NAME]) were visible in the provided excerpt. No issues confirmed.

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5. Compliance

*Plain-text fallback — FAIL:

> Text version is 0 chars

A missing plain-text alternative is a CAN-SPAM violation risk and degrades deliverability scoring with major ISPs (Gmail, Outlook, Yahoo). It also causes rendering failures for plain-text-only clients.

*Authentication headers — unverified:

> Authentication-Results header not found via AgentMail relay

SPF and DKIM pass/fail status cannot be confirmed. Given that the sending domain is emails.skechers.com (a subdomain likely aligned to SFMC), DKIM signing is expected — this should be verified directly against received headers from a live send.

*Unsubscribe: Not verifiable from the truncated source, but CAN-SPAM requires a functional unsubscribe mechanism. No issues confirmed in available HTML.

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6. Email-to-Site Continuity

All 26 destination URLs are behind click.emails.skechers.com redirects — UTM parameters cannot be verified without probing resolved destinations. The campaign ID embedded in the Krux impression beacon (campaignid=TRG_US_EN_BROWSEINSTOCK_1_03202025) suggests back-end attribution is in place, but UTM propagation to skechers.com landing pages is unconfirmed.

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7. Recommendations

| Priority | Issue | Action |

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| High | Plain-text body is empty | Add a plain-text alternative in SFMC with at least a summarized version of the email content |

| High | 3 images served over HTTP | Update image.emails.skechers.com asset URLs to https:// — or confirm CDN redirect is in place and force HTTPS at the template level |

| Medium | 2 images missing alt text | Add descriptive alt text to 041c30ac and f9b5ed32 images in SFMC content blocks |

| Medium | user-scalable=0 blocks pinch-zoom | Remove or change to user-scalable=yes for WCAG 1.4.4 compliance |

| Medium | UTM parameters unverified | Probe resolved destination URLs to confirm UTM tags are present and consistent with campaign |

| Low | missing http-equiv | Correct to |

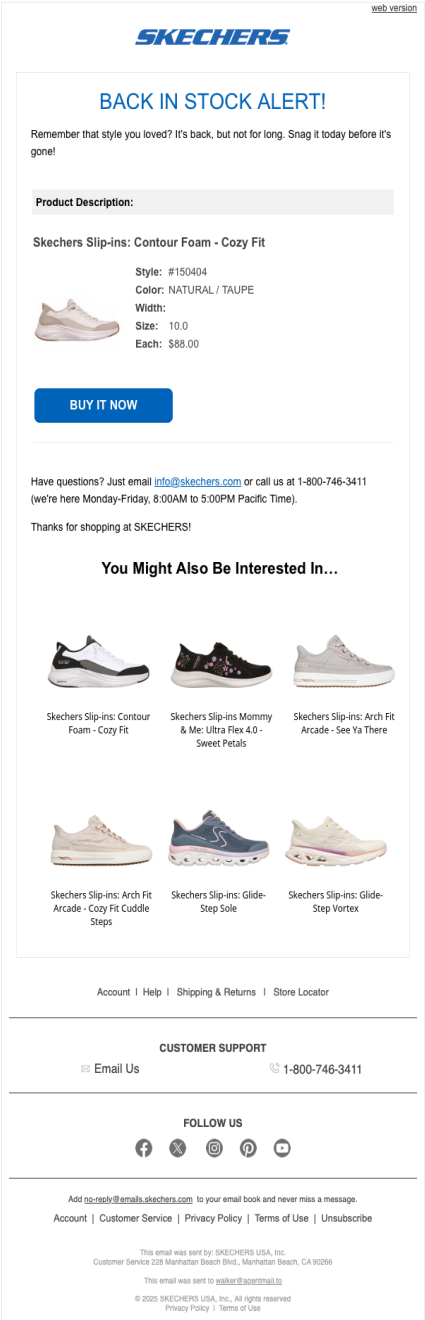
| Low | DKIM/SPF unverified | Confirm authentication pass via received headers in a live inbox test |

## Business Impact Score: 5/10

## Automated QA

Pass rate: 71% • Issues: 1 • Warnings: 1

## Visual Reference




Visual source: hosted web-view render when available.

## Reference Artifacts

Web view: https://view.emails.skechers.com/?qs=eyJkZWtJZCI6IjcwZjhhODQzLTA5MGQtNDBmOC1hOThlLTI5OGM2OGU2ZDE5YiIsImRla1ZlcnNpb24iOjEsIml2IjoiaEpWVHBIZzF6TFh3M0dWalNrelU4UT09IiwiY2lwaGVyVGV4dCI6IjFRL3pQWnpyZzV0NnpVYjBQRWE4YWkyZ2FNVS8vRFBoN2lvTExMSGNBUXQzdElsb3pYNHJQcWxDeTNwYnNManZZNVhITXpCdDBweU5aLzlZYlFGR05Gd0p5azByNjNuWEhUTi91WGIxd1Fjc2NLdnB1TDNiVlN2ZFpQNWFoSlZUcEhnMXpMWHczR1ZqU2t6VThRPT0iLCJhdXRoVGFnIjoiOWNFSExIQ3I2Ymk5MjFVcjNXVCtXZz09In0%3D

Saved HTML:
/Users/alontsang/.openclaw-walker/workspace/reports/email-artifacts/2026-03-26-it-s-back-in-stock-at-skechers-com/message.html

Saved message JSON:
/Users/alontsang/.openclaw-walker/workspace/reports/email-artifacts/2026-03-26-it-s-back-in-stock-at-skechers-com/message.json

## Bottom Line

1. Executive Summary